1.10 HOME MANAGEMENT

Home management of common minor ailments are

Eye wash procedure

- Eye wash should be done as there is discharge or when eyes are sticky.
- Eye wash is done to clean eyes and remove discharge of infective material.

Purpose

- To clean eyes of excess discharge
- To remove foreign bodies which may be soiled or any chemical
- To reduce inflammation and congestion
- To provide soothing effect to the eyes

Equipment and Articles

- Bowl
- Cotton swabs
- Spoon or forceps
- Towel, mackintosh
- Kidney tray
- Eye pad
- Hand washing articles
- Facilities to boil the articles

Procedure

- Explain in detail the procedure
- Wash hands with soap and running water. Let your hands drip from elbow and allow hands to dry in air
- Boil articles and keep ready near bedside
- Protect the patient clothing with mackintosh and towel
- Clean the infected eye first from inner aspect of the eye to outer of the eye.
- Use one swab for one stroke only
- Instill any medicine prescribed
- Wash hands
- Replace the articles
- Record the procedure done and followup if required

Health teaching for prevention of conjunctivitis

Conjunctivitis is easily spread from one person to another, it is very important that others do not use the infected person towel or handkerchief.

- Wash hands after touching eyes
- Avoid bathing in canal or pond water
- Avoid meeting in crowded places
- Try to use dark glasses, if possible

Common Problems	Management
Eye infection: It is the most common condition. Due to infection patient complains of burning, pain, watering of eyes and pain gets worse with light. There may be sticky discharge and eyelids stick together during sleep	Management of such ailment giving an eye wash and application of medicine depending upon severity of conditions. Maintain eye hygiene, wash eyes two or three times a day and prevent dust or strong chemicals close to eye.

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